

Literature Review

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1 Introduction

After discussion with A/Prof Douglas R. Brumley, My literature review will be around Ciliary Flow.

2 Ciliary Flow

Definition 2.1 (Cilium (pl. Cilia)). In the context of eukaryotes, *cilia* are short, hair-like protrusions that grow from the surface as an extension of the membrane. Cilia serve important functions in motility, sensory reception, signalling, and mass transport. Studies of ciliary flows therefore have significant biological implications. [1]

(A paragraph about where cilia are found)

2.1 Corals

Cilia-induced vortical flows are critical for O₂ regulation and metabolite exchange across coral-water interfaces. Against the backdrop of global sea warming, Pacherres et al. found that ciliary beating is important for thermal tolerance for corals. By beating with higher frequency, the corals increase O₂ intake, which alleviates hypoxia observed in temperatures about 35 C° and above. Above about 37 C°, coral mortality accelerated, indicating the existence of a physiological tipping-point for reef-building corals. [2] A shortcoming of this study and its conclusions is that it is unclear what specific temperature-dependent dynamic viscosity function was used in the Navier-Stokes equation for the mathematical simulations. Furthermore, as highlighted in a study of mussels by Riisgård and Larsen [3], higher temperatures lead to low viscosity, which in turn lead to higher cilia beating frequency.

References

- [1] Naoko Mizuno et al. “Structural Studies of Ciliary Components”. In: *Journal of Molecular Biology* 422.2 (Sept. 2012), pp. 163–180. ISSN: 0022-2836. DOI: 10.1016/j.jmb.2012.05.040.
- [2] Cesar O. Pacherres et al. “Acute Temperature Effects on Cilia Beating Increase Coral Deoxygenation”. In: *Science Advances* 12.21 (), eaeg0950. DOI: 10.1126/sciadv.aeg0950. (Visited on 09/02/2026).
- [3] Hu Riisgård and Ps Larsen. “Viscosity of Seawater Controls Beat Frequency of Water-Pumping Cilia and Filtration Rate of Mussels *Mytilus Edulis*”. In: *Marine Ecology Progress Series* 343 (Aug. 2007), pp. 141–150. ISSN: 0171-8630, 1616-1599. DOI: 10.3354/meps06930. (Visited on 08/28/2026).